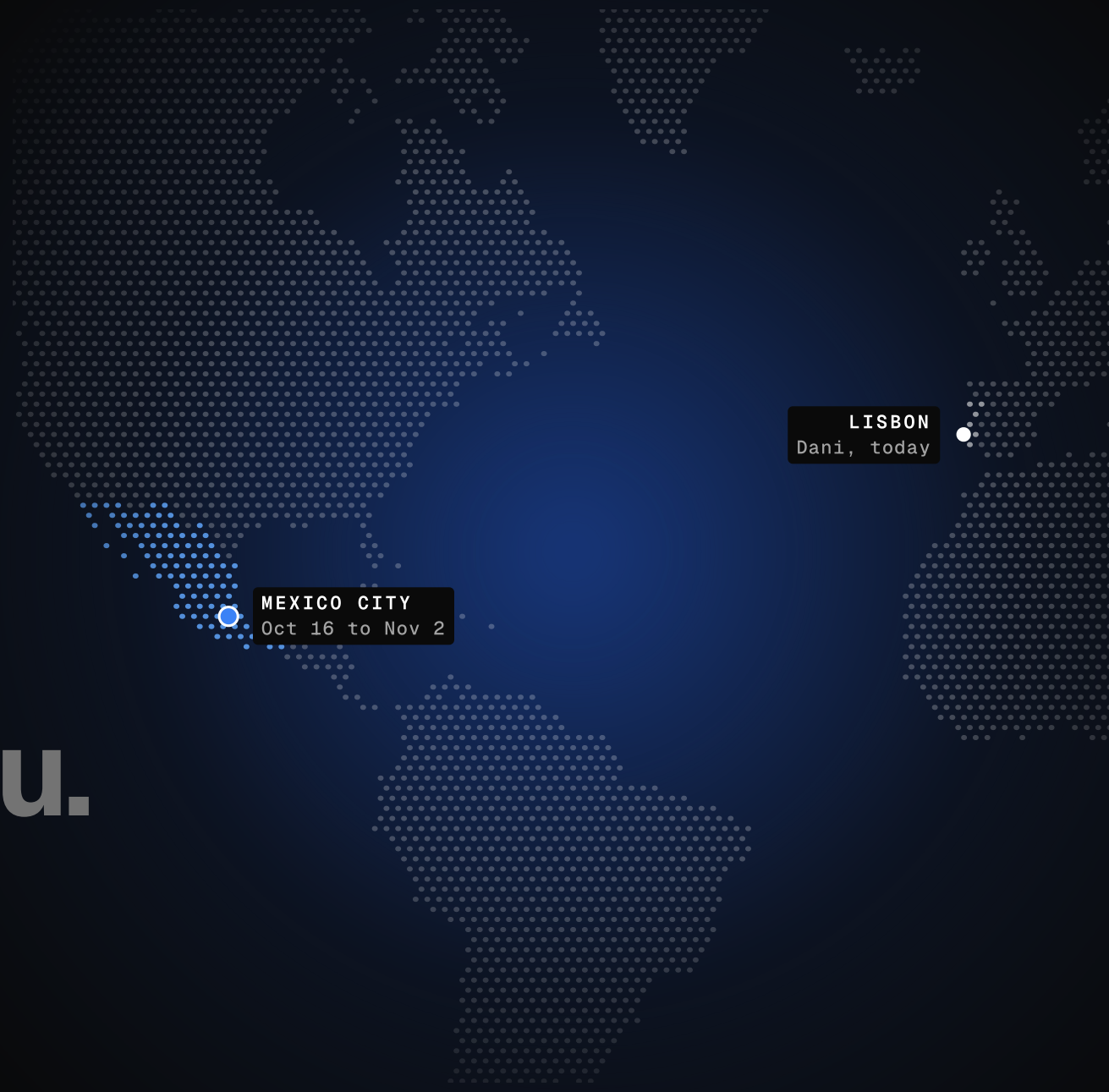
NOMAD.OS




ASSIGNMENT 5 · AI INTERACTION PROTOTYPE

# Books for you.
# Never without you.

A travel agent inside NOMAD.OS. It books trains, hotels, and dinner, and asks before it pays or shares anything.

IDSN 523 · Mitch Kostelecky and Ian Harris · Fall 2026



## SPEAKER NOTES · 01 BOOKS FOR YOU. NEVER WITHOUT YOU.

We're presenting NOMAD.OS, a phone for people without a home base. In Assignment 4 we designed its security layers: a profile for every country you travel to. For this assignment we added one focused layer of AI: a travel agent that lives inside the app.

It books trains, hotels, restaurant tables, and delivery from a chat, and it never pays or shares anything without the traveler's OK. That's the title: books for you, never without you.

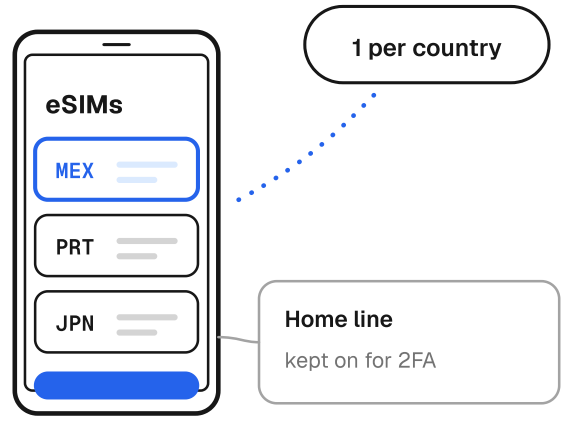
The map is our scenario. Dani is in Lisbon today, Tuesday October 13, and flies to Mexico City on the 16th. Everything you'll see is a clickable prototype with scripted agent replies. There's no live model, but every state is real and you can click through it yourself.

EXISTING PRODUCT AND SELECTED EXPERIENCE

# Airalo.
# An eSIM for every country.

The closest real product to our Numbers layer: a data plan you download for each country, live in minutes.

30M+ travelers · 200+ destinations · local, regional, and global plans




AIRALO'S FLOW TODAY

01 **Pick a destination**
Country or region

02 **Buy a data plan**
Priced by data and days

03 **Install the eSIM**
Before you fly

04 **Connect on arrival**
Turn on the eSIM line

05 **Top up or renew**
Add data any time

SELECTED EXPERIENCE

**The three days before a new country: getting connected, booked, and set up to work.**

WORKS WELL, KEEP IT

- ✓ Fully digital, live in minutes, no SIM swap
- ✓ Home line stays on for calls and codes

WHERE IT STOPS

- × Ends at data. Stays, trains, and dinner happen in other apps
- × Line, roaming, and code tradeoffs are left to you



SPEAKER NOTES · 02 EXISTING PRODUCT: AIRALO

Because we're continuing our Assignment 4 concept, we analyzed a comparable existing product: Airalo, the largest eSIM marketplace. It serves more than 30 million travelers in over 200 destinations, and it's the closest real version of our Numbers layer.

The experience we chose is the few days before a new country: getting connected, booked, and set up to work. In Airalo, that starts with five steps: pick a destination, buy a plan, install the eSIM, connect when you land, and top up.

What works and should stay: it's fully digital, live in minutes, with no SIM swap, and your home line stays on for calls and bank codes. Where it stops: the flow ends at a data connection. The stay, the train, and dinner happen in other apps, and the tradeoffs between lines, roaming, and codes are left to you. Airalo's support chat helps after something breaks, not before.

USER, GOAL, AND CURRENT FLOW

# Dani lands in three days.
# Every step is a different app.

**Dani**
Remote worker, moves every few weeks

GOAL

**Land in Mexico City on Oct 16 connected, booked, and ready to work.**

DECISIONS

Which listing is real, which card pays, what to share, which line gets bank codes

NEEDS TO KNOW

Honest reviews, tested Wi-Fi, refund terms, which banks flag VPN logins

Illustrative composite from our A4 study of 27 public posts

CURRENT FLOW, TUE OCT 13

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Buy an eSIM** Airalo | Works well: live in minutes, home line kept on. | Keep | |
| **Pick a line for bank codes** Help articles | Roaming or codes? Advice conflicts: three answers in one week. | E14 | E23 |
| **Book 17 nights** Booking site | Is the listing real? Is the Wi-Fi good enough to work from? | | |
| **Book a train, dinner, delivery** Three more apps | Card and passport typed in again. No record of who has what. | | |
| **Land and log in** Bank app | A VPN login can freeze the bank, or a work account. | E13 | E26 |

**Worth keeping:** Airalo's speed, real reviews, free cancellation, and Dani's own choices.



SPEAKER NOTES · 03 USER, GOAL, AND CURRENT FLOW

Our user is Dani, an illustrative composite from our Assignment 4 study of 27 public posts by nomads. Dani works remotely and moves every few weeks. The goal is simple: land in Mexico City on October 16 connected, booked, and ready to work.

Here's that flow today. Buying the eSIM in Airalo works well. Then Dani has to decide which line gets bank codes, and the advice online conflicts; one nomad got three different answers in a week. Booking 17 nights means judging whether a listing is real and whether the Wi-Fi is good enough to work from. The train, dinner, and delivery are three more apps, each asking for a card and sometimes a passport, with no record of who has what. And after landing, a VPN login can freeze a bank or work account, which came up again and again in our research.

What already works: Airalo's speed, real reviews, free cancellation, and Dani making the choices. We keep all of it. The E codes point to our Assignment 4 evidence table, in Appendix C.

OPPORTUNITY STATEMENT

When **a remote worker** is trying to **land in a new country ready to work**, they experience **a pile of bookings and setup decisions spread across separate apps** because **each app sells one piece and leaves the risks in between to guesswork**. There is an opportunity to help them **book what they need and arrive set up, approving every payment and every detail shared**.

AI IS NOT AUTOMATICALLY THE ANSWER. WE COMPARED THREE OPTIONS.

### A better checklist

Same list for everyone. It can't know that Wise flags VPN logins in Mexico, or that a listing wants a wire.

Kept as the fallback: every fix shows how to do it yourself.

### A better booking site

Books one thing well, but can't see the card, the network, or what other apps already have.

Simpler, but the risks in between stay with the traveler.

### An AI agent

Our pick

Reads a plain request with dates, card, and network together, then prepares each booking to approve.

Worth it only with a confirm step and hard limits.



SPEAKER NOTES · 04 OPPORTUNITY STATEMENT

Here's our opportunity statement. When a remote worker is trying to land in a new country ready to work, they experience a pile of bookings and setup decisions spread across separate apps, because each app sells one piece and leaves the risks in between to guesswork. There's an opportunity to help them book what they need and arrive set up, approving every payment and every detail shared.

AI isn't automatically the answer, so we compared three options. A better checklist is simple, but it's the same for everyone. It can't know that Wise flags VPN logins in Mexico, or that a listing wants a wire transfer. We kept it as the fallback: every fix shows the steps to do it yourself.

A better booking site books one thing well, but it can't see the card, the network, or what other apps already have. An agent can read a plain request together with dates, card, and network, and prepare each booking. That's only worth it with a confirm step and hard limits, which is the rest of our design.

AI ROLE AND RATIONALE

# Primary role: agent.
# Secondary role: interpreter.

AGENT

**Books trains, hotels, tables, and delivery from one chat.**

Takes actions for the user within defined boundaries.

Agent tab, screen S8a

INTERPRETER

**Check my setup explains each fix for the next country.**

Makes complex information understandable.

Check my setup, screen S8b

### Why it fits

Getting ready is many small actions across services. An agent can take them, inside limits Dani sets.

### What it needs

The request, trip dates, the card it pays with, and network status. Banks, lines, and sign-ins only if Dani shares them.

### What it produces

Shortlists with tested Wi-Fi and reviews, risk flags with reasons, confirm cards, and bookings in Trips.

### Value beyond Airalo

One place to book and arrive set up. Scams flagged before anyone pays. A record of what each booking shared.

### Where it enters

The Agent tab, any time, and Check my setup after a profile downloads. Nothing runs in the background.

### Stays with Dani

Choosing, paying, what gets shared, cancelling, and anything inside a bank.



SPEAKER NOTES · 05 AI ROLE AND RATIONALE

Our primary AI role is agent: it takes actions for the user within defined boundaries. Here, that means booking trains, hotels, tables, and delivery from one chat. The secondary role is interpreter: Check my setup turns the destination plus Dani's banks, lines, and accounts into a short checklist, and explains every item.

Why an agent? Getting ready is many small actions across services, which is what agents are good at, as long as they stay inside limits. It needs the request, the trip dates, the card it pays with, and network status. The setup check sees banks, lines, and sign-ins only if Dani chooses to share them.

It produces shortlists with tested Wi-Fi and reviews, risk flags with reasons, confirm cards, and bookings filed in Trips. The value beyond Airalo is one place to book and arrive set up, with scams flagged before anyone pays. It enters only from the Agent tab, or after a country profile downloads; nothing runs in the background. And choosing, paying, sharing, cancelling, and anything inside a bank stay with Dani.

HUMAN AND AI RESPONSIBILITY MAP

# The agent prepares. Dani decides.

| STAGE | DANI | AGENT | SHARED DECISION |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Initiation** | Opens the Agent tab and asks, or taps a tile | Greets with trip context. Never starts on its own | After a hotel booking, suggests a setup check. Dani chooses to open it |
| **Input and interpretation** | Says what's needed. Picks what the setup check can see | Matches the service, fills in city, dates, and card | Missing details, like a time or party size, get asked, not guessed |
| **Generation or action** | Compares options and reads reviews | Shortlists options. Leaves out risky ones and says why | Dani picks one. Change brings the options back |
| **Decision or approval** | Confirms, changes, or cancels. Face ID over $100 | Shows cost, card, terms, and what's shared first | The confirm card: the agent fills it in, Dani approves it |
| **Completion and review** | Checks Trips. Can cancel any time | Books, files it in Trips, says how it's protected | Setup fixes: the agent suggests, Dani approves, skips, or undoes |

HUMAN JUDGMENT

Which option, paying, what's shared, cancelling

AGENT PREPARES

Shortlists, risk flags, confirm cards, the setup checklist

AGENT DOES ALONE

Searching, filtering, filing bookings in Trips

EXPLICIT PERMISSION

Anything that costs money or shares details. Face ID over $100

EXPLAINS ITSELF

When it leaves something out, says no, or suggests a fix

DANI STEPS IN

Change or Cancel on every card. Cancel later from Trips

IF IT'S WRONG

Dani approved the card, so NOMAD.OS answers for what the card showed

NEVER ALLOWED

Pay by bank transfer or off the booking site. Change bank settings. Hide or fake location. Act without an OK.



SPEAKER NOTES · 06 RESPONSIBILITY MAP

This is how work and decisions are split. The pattern in every row: the agent prepares, Dani decides.

At initiation, Dani opens the Agent tab and asks. The agent never starts on its own; the one suggestion it makes is a setup check after a hotel booking, and Dani chooses whether to open it. For input, Dani says what's needed and picks what the setup check can see. The agent fills in city, dates, and card, and asks for anything missing, like a time or party size. For generation, it shortlists and leaves out risky options, always saying why. The decision is the confirm card: the agent fills it in with the cost, card, terms, and what gets shared, and Dani confirms, changes, or cancels. Over 100 dollars, that takes Face ID. At completion, it files the booking in Trips, and Dani can cancel later.

On the right are our answers to the map questions. If the agent is wrong, Dani approved what the card showed, so NOMAD.OS answers for the card being complete and correct. And it's never allowed to pay by transfer or off the booking site, change bank settings, or hide location.

PROPOSED AI INTERACTION FLOW

# Eight steps, one decision point.
# The agent never skips the confirm.

01
**Entry**
Agent tab, or Check my setup after a profile downloads.
`Four tiles, one text field`

02
**User input**
A plain request or a tap. The setup check starts with what to share.
`“Book a hotel in Mexico City”`

03
**Interpretation**
Matches the service, then fills in city, dates, and card.
`Hotels, Oct 16 to Nov 2`

04
**AI response**
A shortlist with tested Wi-Fi and reviews. Risky options left out, with why.
`3 hotels, 1 not offered`

05
**Human decision**
A confirm card: cost, card, terms, what’s shared. Confirm, change, or cancel.
`Face ID over $100. Change goes back to 04`

06
**Feedback**
Typing, then a receipt that says how it’s protected.
`“Wi-Fi tested at 210 Mbps”`

07
**Recovery**
Refuses unsafe payments and offers another way. Any booking can be cancelled.
`“I didn’t book Pátio 14”`

08
**Exit**
Files it in Trips, names what’s left, then waits.
`“2 things to fix before you fly”`

**Uncertainty, shown plainly**
Prices show an about-amount in dollars. Wi-Fi speeds come from other nomads’ tests. Ratings show how many reviews.

**When it can’t help**
It says what it can do instead, or hands off: “You can call Pátio 14 yourself.” Nothing is left half done.



SPEAKER NOTES · 07 INTERACTION FLOW

Here’s the interaction over time, using the hotel booking. Entry is the Agent tab, with four tiles and a text field. Dani taps Book a hotel or types the request. The system matches it to hotels and fills in the trip: Mexico City, October 16 to November 2. The agent responds with three hotels, each with Wi-Fi other nomads tested, and leaves one listing out, with the reason.

The human decision is the center of the flow. The confirm card shows everything that matters, and Dani can confirm, change, or cancel. Change loops back to the options.

Feedback is a typing state, then a receipt that says how the booking is protected. We show uncertainty plainly: prices are about-amounts in dollars, Wi-Fi speeds are measured by other nomads, and ratings show how many reviews they’re based on. Recovery covers two cases: the agent refuses an unsafe payment and offers another way, and every booking can be cancelled later. Finally, it files the booking in Trips, names what’s left before the flight, and stops.

PROTOTYPE: BOOKING PATH

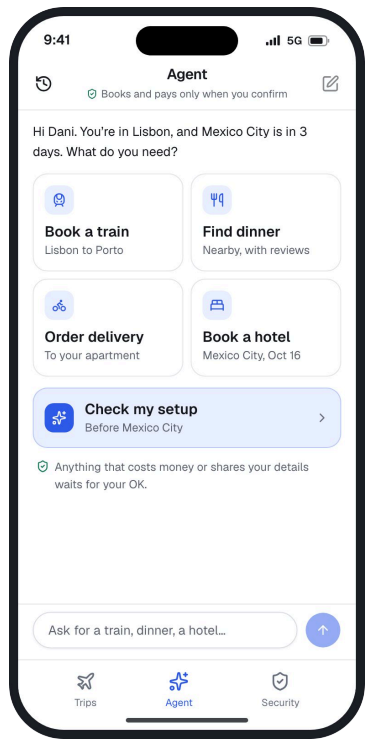
# Ask, compare, approve.
# Nothing books until Dani confirms.

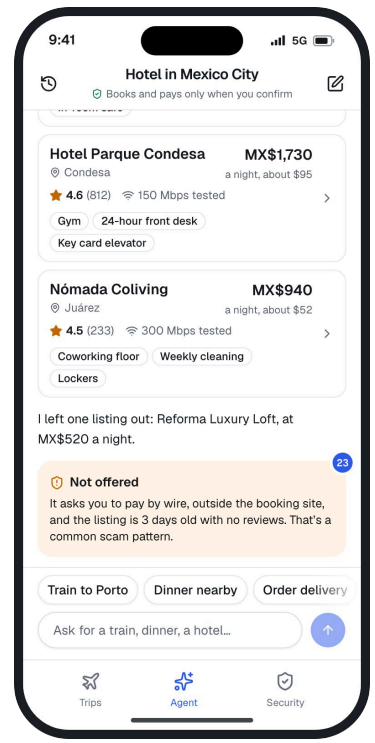
20 Every booking ends in a confirm card. Nothing books on its own.

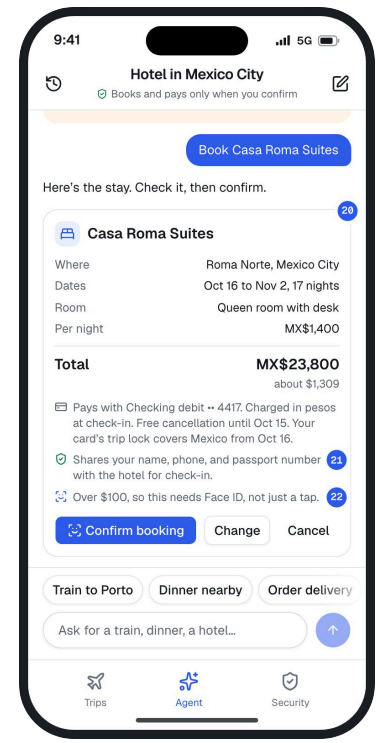
21 Says exactly what gets shared, and with whom.

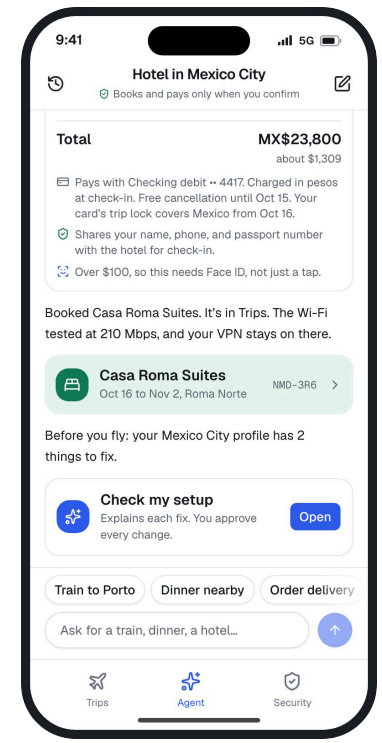
22 Big purchases need Face ID, not just a tap.

23 Won't pay by transfer or off the booking site. Says why.




### 01 Ask
Tiles or plain words. The header says it books and pays only when Dani confirms.

### 02 Compare
Wi-Fi tested by other nomads. A listing that wants a wire is left out, with why.

### 03 Approve
Dates, total in pesos and dollars, the card, and what the hotel gets.

### 04 Booked
Filed in Trips with a reference. Then one next step: 2 fixes before the flight.

Clickable prototype with scripted agent replies. Screen S8a, at #agent



SPEAKER NOTES · 08 PROTOTYPE: BOOKING PATH

This is the booking path in the prototype, screen S8a. First, Ask: four tiles or plain words, and the header always says the agent books and pays only when you confirm.

Second, Compare: three hotels with Wi-Fi other nomads tested. Callout 23: one listing asks for a wire transfer outside the booking site, a common scam pattern, so the agent leaves it out and says so instead of quietly hiding it.

Third, Approve. Callout 20: every booking ends in a confirm card with the dates, the total in pesos and about in dollars, and the card it pays with. Callout 21: it says exactly what gets shared, here name, phone, and passport number for check-in. Callout 22: it's over 100 dollars, so it needs Face ID, not just a tap.

Fourth, Booked: it lands in Trips with a reference number, and the agent points to one next step: two things to fix before the flight. That's where the interpreter role picks up.

PROTOTYPE: CONTROL AND RECOVERY

# Control stays with Dani.
## Even when the agent says no.

STATES WE BUILT

**Booking**

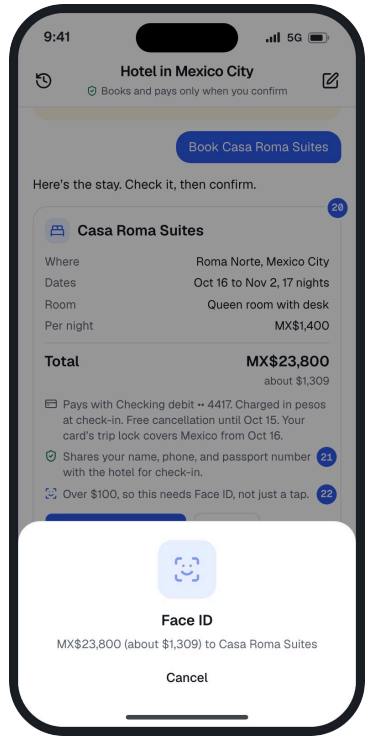
Options · Typing · Confirm · Face ID · Booked · Changed · Cancelled

**Safety**

Not offered · Refused · Can't help

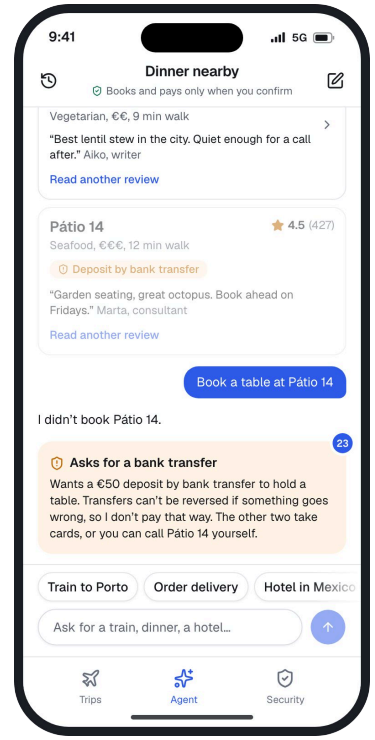
**Setup**

Share · Checking · Approve · Skip · Undo



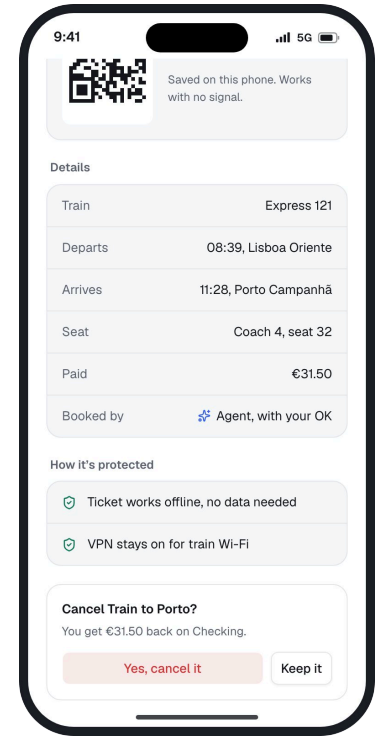

**01 Verify**

Over $100, so Face ID with the amount and the hotel. Cancel backs out.



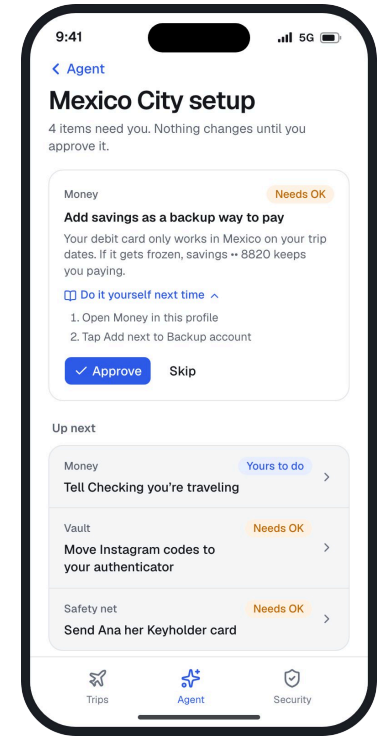

**02 Refuse**

A €50 deposit by transfer. It won't pay that way, says why, and offers two others.




**03 Undo**

Any booking cancels from Trips, with the refund and card spelled out.




**04 Learn**

Each fix says why and how to do it yourself. Approve, skip, or undo.



SPEAKER NOTES · 09 PROTOTYPE: CONTROL AND RECOVERY

This slide is about control and recovery. Verify: confirming the hotel opens Face ID with the amount and the hotel's name. Cancel backs out, and nothing is booked or shared.

Refuse: Dani asks to book a table at Pátio 14, which wants a 50 euro deposit by bank transfer. Transfers can't be reversed, so the agent won't pay that way. It says why, points to the two other places, and leaves the option to call the restaurant directly.

Undo: any booking can be cancelled from Trips. The cancel prompt says exactly how much comes back, and to which card.

Learn: Check my setup lists what needs Dani, explains why, and has a Do it yourself next time section with the steps. Nothing changes until Dani approves, and approvals can be undone.

On the left are the states we built: booking, safety, and setup states, including a reply for requests it can't handle, where it says what it can do instead.

HUMAN FLOURISHING

# Agency and learning.
# Help that doesn’t take over.

| | OPPORTUNITY | RISK | SAFEGUARD |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Agency and autonomy**<br>Does it keep meaningful choice and control? | Dani makes every choice that matters: which option, which card, what’s shared. | Confirm fatigue: tapping yes without reading. Or a shortlist that quietly narrows the choice. | Short confirm cards. Face ID only over $100, so it still means something. Anything left out is shown, with why. |
| **Learning and capability**<br>Does it build knowledge, judgment, or skills? | Every flag and fix explains why, so Dani learns what a risky listing or setup looks like. | Dependence: Dani stops judging listings or setting up lines, and can’t travel without the agent. | Do it yourself next time, on every fix. Bank changes always stay with Dani. |

THE TENSION

Filtering scams protects Dani, but every hidden listing is a choice made on Dani’s behalf. So nothing is hidden silently.

HOW WE’D TEST IT

Five nomads, with a teammate answering as the agent from the operator panel. Do people read the confirm card? Can they repeat a fix alone a week later?



SPEAKER NOTES · 10 HUMAN FLOURISHING

We used two flourishing dimensions: agency and autonomy, and learning and capability.

For agency, the opportunity is that Dani makes every choice that matters: which option, which card, what’s shared. The risk is confirm fatigue, tapping yes without reading, or a shortlist that quietly narrows the choice. Our safeguards: confirm cards stay short, Face ID only appears over 100 dollars so it still means something, and anything the agent leaves out is shown with the reason.

For learning, every flag and fix explains why, so Dani builds judgment about risky listings and setups. The risk is dependence: never learning to judge a listing or set up a line. So every setup fix includes do-it-yourself steps, and bank changes always stay with Dani.

The tension we’re holding: filtering scams protects Dani, but every hidden listing is a choice made on Dani’s behalf. That’s why nothing is hidden silently.

Next, we’d test with five nomads, with a teammate answering as the agent from the operator panel. We’d watch whether people read the confirm card, and whether they can repeat a fix on their own a week later. Thank you.

APPENDIX A

# Where the AI enters, and where it stops.

**What activates it?**
Dani opens the Agent tab, or taps Check my setup after a profile downloads. Nothing runs in the background.

**Does it ask, or suggest?**
Dani asks. Its one suggestion: after a hotel booking, it points to setup fixes, and Dani decides whether to open them.

**What information does it use?**
The request, trip city and dates, the card on file, and network status. The setup check sees only what Dani shares.

**Does Dani know what it uses?**
Yes. The share screen lists each source, and every confirm card says what gets shared, and with whom.

**What does it produce?**
Shortlists, risk flags with reasons, confirm cards, bookings in Trips, and a setup checklist.

**What needs approval?**
Anything that costs money or shares personal details. Over $100 also needs Face ID.

**Can Dani edit, reject, or reverse it?**
Change or Cancel on every card. Bookings cancel from Trips. Setup approvals can be undone, except a sent Keyholder card.

**How does it show uncertainty?**
Prices are about-amounts in dollars, Wi-Fi speeds come from other nomads' tests, and ratings show review counts.

**What if it can't finish?**
It says so, explains why, and offers another way: a different option, or the steps to do it yourself.

**When does it stop?**
After the receipt and one next step. It never chains bookings on its own.

**How does control return?**
The booking sits in Trips, the chat waits, and every thread is saved in history.



SPEAKER NOTES · 11 APPENDIX A: PLACING THE AI

Backup for questions about Part 4: exactly where the AI enters the experience, what it uses, and how control returns to the user.

APPENDIX B · FROM ASSIGNMENT 4

# Opportunity statements and value proposition.

| AREA | OPPORTUNITY STATEMENT | HOW MIGHT WE |
|---|---|---|
| **Network judgment** | Members value **competence** and participate through **VPN and travel-router routines**, but experience tension between **fear-driven advice** and **unclear real risk**. | How might we help nomads judge network risk with confidence without reinforcing fear-driven tool buying? |
| **Security that moves with you** Selected | Members value **self-reliance and freedom of movement** and participate through **second phones, two numbers, and pre-departure prep**, but experience tension between **security systems that assume a home** and **lives spent crossing borders**. | How might we help nomads arrive in any country already set up, and recover from anywhere, without assuming a home or hiding where they are? |
| **Money that keeps moving** | Members value **freedom of movement** and participate through **multi-bank, multi-app money stacks**, but experience tension between **automated compliance** and **travel patterns that look suspicious**. | How might we help nomads keep access to money during a freeze without needing a home bank to fall back on? |

VALUE PROPOSITION

For **digital nomads and remote workers** who value **self-reliance and freedom of movement** but experience **security systems that assume a home**, NOMAD.OS helps them **arrive in any country already set up, and recover from anywhere** by **downloading one profile per country that sets four layers: network, money, numbers, and a safety net**.



SPEAKER NOTES · 12 APPENDIX B: OPPORTUNITY STATEMENTS

From Assignment 4: our three opportunity areas, written with the assignment template, and the value proposition for the one we chose. This assignment's agent grows out of the selected area: arrive set up, and recover from anywhere.

# Evidence table, 1 of 3 E1 to E9

| ID | SOURCE | OBSERVATION | INTERPRETATION | VALUE | TENSION |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| E1 | Creator setup guides, Jul and Oct 2026 | Gear-by-gear stacks: a named travel router running WireGuard, multiple eSIMs, priced and weighed per layer. | The setup itself is a display of competence. | Preparedness, control | Preparedness vs. burden and cost |
| E2 | Nomad tools blog, Sep 2026 | Argues VPN value depends on the work; light, non-sensitive work on a personal hotspot may not need one. | Nuance entering a VPN-maximal conversation. | Practicality | Fear vs. actual need |
| E3 | VPN vendor blog, Aug 2026 | Opens by saying most public Wi-Fi guides sell fear or sell a VPN; calls a VPN often overkill for low-risk use. | Even sellers distance themselves from fear marketing. | Calm competence | Marketing vs. trust |
| E4 | VPN vendor blog, two posts, Jul and Aug 2026 | One post says HTTPS protects you from hackers on public Wi-Fi; the other says HTTPS alone won't keep you safe. | Guidance is unstable even within one source. | Clarity | Conflicting advice |
| E5 | VPN blog, Jul 31, 2026; travel blog comments, 2026 | Readers describe buying travel routers so an employer sees a home IP; the vendor warns detection is likely. | Security gear doubles as concealment. | Freedom | Protection vs. concealment |
| E6 | Travel blog post and reader comment, Jul 2026 | A perpetual traveler's phone is stolen; a reader notes phones are grabbed while unlocked in use. | Risk peaks at the moment of use, not at rest. | Vigilance | Convenience vs. safety |
| E7 | Phone accessory brand blog, Aug 2026 | Recommends carrying a secondary "burner" phone for risky situations abroad. | Redundancy extends to whole devices. | Preparedness | More gear vs. simplicity |
| E8 | Hacker News, Ask HN, Sep 2026 (not travel-specific) | After a phone theft, the poster can't reach banking, email, or cloud files. Replies: keep two signed-in devices; keep codes in a password manager. | One device is a single point of failure; peers prescribe redundancy. | Self-reliance, peer help | Security vs. access |
| E9 | Q&A help site, Oct 2026 (traveler, not confirmed remote worker) | Traveler in New Zealand is locked out of Gmail; her recovery number is an Australian line she can't use. | Recovery paths assume you're near home. | Access | Mobility vs. verification |



SPEAKER NOTES · 13 APPENDIX C: EVIDENCE TABLE, 1 OF 3

From Assignment 4: the evidence behind every E code, with the source, what we observed, our interpretation, the value, and the tension. Items 1 to 9.

# Evidence table, 2 of 3 E10 to E18

| ID | SOURCE | OBSERVATION | INTERPRETATION | VALUE | TENSION |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| E10 | Google Account Help, current page (context) | Recovery tips: use a familiar device and a location where you usually sign in, like home or work. | Platform policy encodes a home. | n/a | Home assumption |
| E11 | Apple Support, current page (context) | Stolen Device Protection adds biometric checks and a delay when the phone is away from familiar locations. | The same assumption, in theft protection. | n/a | Home assumption |
| E12 | r/digitalnomad thread, Apr 22, 2026 (also summarized in May 2026) | About $68k held by a fintech app for nearly 6 months; 230+ comments. Replies: it isn't a bank, keep a real one; regulator complaints released funds. Update: money returned late May. | Failure stories become community rules. | Collective knowledge | Convenience vs. control of money |
| E13 | Expat VPN site, Oct 2026; nomad tax guide, Jun 2026 | One says a dedicated-IP VPN ends repeated selfie checks; the other says VPNs can trigger fraud flags and freezes. | The same tool is sold as cure and blamed as cause. | Access | Conflicting advice |
| E14 | Expat phone setup guide, May 2026 | Banks and government portals send codes only to real US numbers, mostly not VoIP; recommends a cheap carrier line kept active from abroad. | Nomads rebuild a "home" number. | Continuity | Freedom vs. home dependence |
| E15 | Nomad blog, Apr 2026 (8 years nomadic) | Calls the password manager the keystone; keeps a printed emergency kit sealed with a trusted person at home; warns against carrying the only copy. | Recovery depends on people and place. | Care, preparedness | Freedom vs. home dependence |
| E16 | r/digitalnomad, ~Jun 2026, 70+ comments | PSA that the phone is the key to everything; replies advise storing IMEI and carrier details in a password manager; one reply also locked out of Google. | The phone is a single point of failure, and the community knows it. | Preparedness | Security vs. access |
| E17 | r/digitalnomad, ~Aug 2026, 40+ comments | Thread on carrying a secondary phone; the top answer adopted it after a phone snatch in Barcelona. | Redundancy is learned through failure. | Preparedness | More gear vs. simplicity |
| E18 | r/digitalnomad, May to Oct 2026, three threads | Full-time travel "ruined" a poster's number; replies split life across two numbers; the keep-your-US-number question recurs and draws weary replies. | The home number is infrastructure nomads must maintain from afar. | Continuity | Freedom vs. home dependence |



SPEAKER NOTES · 14 APPENDIX C: EVIDENCE TABLE, 2 OF 3

Items 10 to 18, including the two platform policies that assume a home, and the threads about keeping a home number alive for codes.

APPENDIX C · FROM ASSIGNMENT 4

# Evidence table, 3 of 3 E19 to E27

| ID | SOURCE | OBSERVATION | INTERPRETATION | VALUE | TENSION |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| E19 | r/digitalnomad, ~May 2026, 160+ comments | A newcomer about to quit and travel is told to carry two phones and absolutely keep a home number for bank and government codes. | Status is passed down as rules for newcomers. | Belonging, care | Freedom vs. home dependence |
| E20 | r/digitalnomad, Apr to Aug 2026, 120 to 390+ comments | Stealth-nomading threads reference the subreddit wiki setup (travel router, tunnel home, kill switch); a reply says IT reads a foreign login as stolen credentials. | Concealment is organized and documented, not fringe; corporate security also assumes a home. | Freedom, control | Protection vs. concealment |
| E21 | r/digitalnomad, ~May 2026, 10 to 20+ comments | Newcomers ask whether a $10k transfer will trigger a freeze, and report transfers held for extra security checks. | Failure stories shape behavior before failure happens. | Control of money | Convenience vs. control |
| E22 | X, Sep 21, 2026, creator (~23.5k followers), 367 likes | Phone stolen by motorbike thieves in Asunción; cards added to Apple Pay and thousands taken; 2FA tied to the stolen phone and a Spanish SIM, so he flew to Spain to recover the number. | Recovery can require physically returning to a “home” country. | Self-reliance | Freedom vs. home dependence |
| E23 | X, Oct 5 to 8, 2026, three small accounts | One says get your cell number out of 2FA and use Google Voice; one says banks may refuse Voice numbers, so test each bank; one says keep the home SIM on just for codes. | Advice conflicts in the same week, with no shared answer. | Clarity | Conflicting advice |
| E24 | X, Oct 6, 2026, developer creator (~400k) | Praises a GL.iNet travel router for making travel easier; a VPN is optional. | The router is also a mainstream convenience gadget, not only a security or concealment tool. | Convenience | (Complicates the burden tension) |
| E25 | X, Oct 1, 2026, small nomad account | Describes briefing an eSIM provider on 2FA, eSIM, and the financial risks of a stolen phone. | The market is starting to notice the same gap. | n/a | Competitive signal |
| E26 | r/digitalnomad, ~May 27, 2026, 38 upvotes, 39 comments | A work account was frozen after using a consumer VPN while traveling; replies say commercial VPNs are easy to detect and suggest self-hosting at a parent’s house. | The security tool triggers the lockout, and the fix routes back through home. | Access | Security vs. access |
| E27 | r/GlInet, ~Apr 8, 2026, 13 comments (verified via a listing) | A newcomer offers to pay for help setting up a travel router to present a home IP; replies cover home-side servers, 2FA, and disabling Wi-Fi on work laptops. | Concealment setups are hard enough that newcomers pay for help. | Freedom | Protection vs. concealment |



SPEAKER NOTES · 15 APPENDIX C: EVIDENCE TABLE, 3 OF 3

Items 19 to 27, including E22, the stolen phone in Asunción, and E23, three conflicting answers in one week.

# Research-to-design traceability.

| EVIDENCE | WHAT WE OBSERVED OR CONCLUDED | DESIGN RESPONSE |
|---|---|---|
| E10 E11 E22 | Recovery keys off home; one nomad flew home to get a number back. | Safety net: Break Glass from any browser; a Keyholder replaces the familiar-place check. (S6, S7) |
| E13 E23 E26 | The right answer depends on the country and the bank. | Country profiles, with dated reports for each country. (S1, S2) |
| E2 E3 E4 | VPNs: needed versus overkill, and fear-driven advice. | Network layer: VPN on only for untrusted Wi-Fi. (S3) |
| E13 E26 | VPNs trigger bank and work-account freezes. | Network layer: apps that flag VPNs go direct. (S3) |
| E6 E22 | Thieves add cards to wallets and move money fast. | Money layer: cards locked to trip dates and places. (S4) |
| E12 E21 | Fintech freezes strand money for months. | Money layer: a backup way to pay and a freeze plan. (S4) |
| E14 E18 E19 | Nomads keep a home number alive for codes. | Numbers layer: home line for codes, local eSIM for data. (S5) |
| E8 E23 | Advice splits on SMS versus other code methods. | Numbers layer: codes that can leave SMS move to an authenticator. (S5) |
| E15 E17 | Nomads leave kits with family and add backups after a theft. | Safety net: a Keyholder with a split key. (S6) |
| E5 E20 | Security gear is used to hide location from employers. | Principle: encrypt, don’t disguise. The VPN exits where you are. (Principles) |



SPEAKER NOTES · 16 APPENDIX D: TRACEABILITY

From Assignment 4: how each finding maps to a design response, and to the screen in the prototype that carries it.

# Sources for every evidence item.

| | |
|---|---|
| E1 | dev.to/notifyshow/the-ultimate-digital-nomad-setup-minimalist-tech-and-working-from-anywhere-179k; nomadstoolslab.com/digital-nomad-setup-guide-2026 |
| E2 | ontheroadtools.com/vpn-for-digital-nomads-do-you-actually-need-one |
| E3 | windscribe.com/blog/how-to-use-public-wi-fi-safely |
| E4 | protonvpn.com/blog/vpn-myths; protonvpn.com/blog/public-wifi-and-https |
| E5 | vpn.pro/blog/can-your-employer-detect-that-youre-using-a-vpn-while-working-remotely; indietraveller.co/best-travel-vpn (comments) |
| E6 | johnnyjet.com/dont-fall-for-this-new-phone-theft-scam-targeting-tourists |
| E7 | phoneloops.com/blogs/posts/phone-security-while-traveling-europe-prevent-theft-stay-safe-in-2026 |
| E8 | news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49742976 |
| E9 | justanswer.com/email/jeery-locked-gmail-account-currently-overseas-none.html |
| E10 | support.google.com/accounts/answer/7299973 |
| E11 | support.apple.com/120340 |
| E12 | reddit.com/r/digitalnomad/comments/1ssjy5m; summary at moveandmoney.com/blog-fintech-account-frozen-2026 |
| E13 | safeexpatvpn.com/revolut-account-restricted-abroad; nomadtaxguide.com/blog/digital-nomad-banking-guide |
| E14 | expatretireguide.com/money/phone-setup |
| E15 | tonydehnke.com/blog/digital-nomad-backup-tools |
| E16 | reddit.com/r/digitalnomad/comments/1uh3o4f |
| E17 | reddit.com/r/digitalnomad/comments/1vwj8pg |
| E18 | reddit.com/r/digitalnomad/comments/1w75mkf; 1wyr9jc; 1t8q1ig |
| E19 | reddit.com/r/digitalnomad/comments/1ti45hs |
| E20 | reddit.com/r/digitalnomad/comments/1vzmfww; 1tr5hou; 1slwlzs |
| E21 | reddit.com/r/digitalnomad/comments/1tqfsq4; 1tlf6pc |
| E22 | x.com/hispanicnomad/status/2102094776187134436 |
| E23 | x.com/GabeLenz/status/2108298536093896991; x.com/StephenZhou1004/status/2108115835294216253; x.com/nexkit2026/status/2107078468936908918 |
| E24 | x.com/theo/status/2107590392128704776 |
| E25 | x.com/baddigitalnomad/status/2105673102768419026 |
| E26 | reddit.com/r/digitalnomad/comments/1tp3a7b |
| E27 | reddit.com/r/GllNet/comments/1sfksl9 |

Reddit items come from Google listings filtered to the study window, dates estimated from post IDs; X posts were opened and checked by hand. Dates are publication or comment dates where shown; otherwise estimated from the page's indexed age and given to the month. Policy pages were read in October 2026. Usernames are omitted throughout.



SPEAKER NOTES · 17 APPENDIX E: EVIDENCE SOURCES

From Assignment 4: the link for every evidence item, and how we collected and dated them.

APPENDIX F

# References.


| | |
|---|---|
| Airalo. (2026, June 2). *Airalo surpasses 30 million users* [Press release]. https://www.airalo.com/about-us/press-releases/airalo-surpasses-30-million-users | Existing product analysis |
| Amershi, S., Weld, D., Vorvoreanu, M., Fourney, A., Nushi, B., Collisson, P., Suh, J., Iqbal, S., Bennett, P. N., Inkpen, K., Teevan, J., Kikin-Gil, R., & Horvitz, E. (2019). Guidelines for human-AI interaction. *Proceedings of CHI 2019*. https://doi.org/10.1145/3290605.3300233 | Explain, confirm, and support correction |
| Google PAIR. (2021). *People + AI guidebook*. https://pair.withgoogle.com/guidebook | Trust, feedback, and errors |
| OpenAI. (2025, January 23). *Introducing Operator*. https://openai.com/blog/introducing-operator | Precedent: an agent that asks before it buys |
| Parasuraman, R., Sheridan, T. B., & Wickens, C. D. (2000). A model for types and levels of human interaction with automation. *IEEE Transactions on Systems, Man, and Cybernetics, Part A, 30*(3), 286-297. https://doi.org/10.1109/3468.844354 | How much the agent does on its own |
| Shneiderman, B. (2022). *Human-centered AI*. Oxford University Press. | High automation with high human control |
| Federal Trade Commission. (n.d.). *Avoid scams when you travel*. Consumer Advice. https://consumer.ftc.gov/articles/avoid-scams-when-you-travel | Wire transfers as a scam signal |
| NOMAD.OS team. (2026). *Assignment 4 research: 27 public posts on how nomads stay secure, E1 to E27*. IDSN 523. | Evidence codes on slide 3, in full in Appendix C |




SPEAKER NOTES · 18 APPENDIX F: REFERENCES

Products, precedents, and research we used. The E codes on slide 3 point to our Assignment 4 evidence table in Appendix C, with a link for each item in Appendix E.